



Settlements

Urban areas are very built-up. Houses, shops, offices, and other buildings are crammed in close together.

Facilities

Usually, there are lots of shops, schools, libraries, and hospitals. There may also be sports centres and swimming pools.

Population

In many countries, most of the population now live in towns and cities. This is because there are plenty of jobs and houses there.

Transport

Most towns and cities have good transport links. These include roads for buses and cars, railways, and airports.

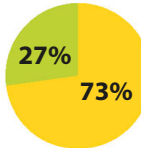
Urban

Large numbers of people live close to each other in urban areas. There are many buildings and roads. People in cities do lots of different jobs.

Rural and urban populations

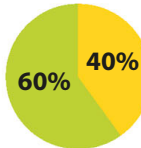
More and more people across the world are moving from rural to urban areas, where there are more jobs that are often better paid.

■ Rural ■ Urban



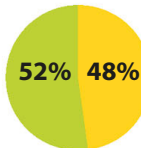
Europe

Most people in Europe live in urban areas. The population of many cities is still growing.



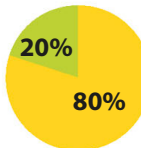
Africa

Here, more of the work is on farms. Therefore, most people remain in rural areas.



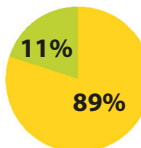
Asia

The world's largest city, Tokyo, is in Asia. But just over half of all Asians live in rural areas.



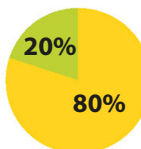
South America

The urban population here is expanding rapidly. Most people now live in cities.



Australia

Some islands are still very rural, but most people live in cities, dotted along the coast.



North America

Wide open spaces are common here, but few people live in them. Most prefer city life.